

Delaware County Metropolitan Planning Commission Meeting July 9th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IrYDj5vruP0
Publication Date	2026-07-10T10:49:13Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: July 2026 (Regular Meeting)

Report Publication: Comprehensive Municipal Meeting Analysis

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called to order the regular meeting of the Delaware-Muncie Metropolitan Plan Commission at [00:10:11](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Steven Brand, Nate Carroll, Jerry Dishman, Emily Kring, Owen Lecher, Ricky Seip, and Chris Smith.
 - **Members Absent:** Tom Borchers, Teresa Hensley, Richard Ivy, Jesse Landis, and Adam Leech.
 - **Quorum:** The presiding officer explicitly noted that a quorum was established [00:11:26](#).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance led by the board [00:10:19](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - The minutes from the June meeting were not yet received. A motion was made and seconded to continue (table) the approval of the June meeting minutes [00:11:41](#).
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:11:57](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Item 1 [00:13:23](#) — Ordinance MPC 05-26Z: Zone Change Request (Integrated Solutions LLC)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:13:23](#) MPC 05-26Z, Jurisdiction: County Commissioners. Consideration of an appeal filed by Integrated Solutions LLC requesting a change in zone from the **F (Farming) Zone** to the **BV (Variety Business) Zone** at the premises of **7600 South State Road 67, Salem Township**.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Van Nice, Ashton Land Surveyor ([00:13:58](#)).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The applicant explained that the parcel is currently vacant with an existing garage. The intent is to use the garage and add a pole barn for storing business trucks (plumbing business, "Dr. Bath") and materials, with potential future use for mini-warehouses or product viewing.
 - Board members questioned the split of the recently platted property (Lot 2 vs. the northern residential lot). Brent Utermark, the property owner, clarified that the northern lot is a remodeled house intended for residential use ([00:24:29](#)).
 - Discussion also covered business signage versus billboards; the applicant clarified they intend to put up on-premise business signage rather than off-premise billboards ([00:26:24](#)).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - [00:17:32](#) **Richard Burns:** Spoke in support, stating he will live in the northern residential lot and has no problem with the business next door.
 - [00:18:19](#) **Charlotte Laws & Tim Lawless (Residents):** Spoke in opposition. They expressed concerns about past property conditions, historical uses, environmental/soil issues from vehicle maintenance, property values, and the visual impact of stored vehicles (ambulances used for branding). Tim Lawless later reiterated concerns regarding vehicle condition and transport ([00:29:55](#)).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**

- A motion for a favorable recommendation failed on a tie roll call vote (3 Yes, 3 No) [00:32:30](#).
 - **Disposition:** Continued / Tabled to the next meeting on August 6th [00:32:35](#).
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Item 2 [00:33:18](#) — Ordinance MPC 06-26Z: Zone Change Request (Peggy Rice)

- **Item Identifier & Title:** [00:33:18](#) MPC 06-26Z, Jurisdiction: County Commissioners.
Consideration of an appeal filed by Peggy Rice requesting a zone change from split zoning (R1 Residence Zone and F Farming Zone) to the **F (Farming) Zone** at **6609 East Windsor Road**, and from R1 Residence Zone to F Farming Zone at **6601 East Windsor Road** (Perry Township).
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kathy Van Nice, Ashton Land Surveyor ([00:33:59](#)).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The applicant explained that the owner wants to unify both parcels under the **Farming Zone** to establish an outdoor educational facility/wildlife refuge named “Sarah’s Niche” (established in memory of her late daughter) ([00:35:04](#), [00:40:57](#)).
 - Future plans involve platting changes and seeking variances regarding lot setbacks and access via an easement instead of a direct public right-of-way [00:34:34](#).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - [00:36:11](#) **William Garrett:** Spoke seeking information rather than direct opposition. He inquired about whether the educational facility would be considered a school and if property taxes or neighborhood insurance rates would be affected. Staff and representatives clarified that it is a non-profit outdoor educational nature program and unlikely to alter residential taxes.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - A motion for a favorable recommendation was made and seconded [00:43:27](#).
 - **Roll Call Vote:** Passed unanimously (6 Yes, 0 No) [00:43:57](#).
 - **Disposition:** Favorable recommendation forwarded to the County Commissioners for consideration on July 20th at 9:00 a.m. [00:43:57](#)
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: General public comments occurred within specific item hearings above rather than a separate general forum).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements ([00:44:26](#)):**
 - **Permitting & Activity Report:** June saw 82 permits issued (429 total year-to-date through June). Notable commercial projects included Muncie Aviation hangar, Selma

Middle School interior renovations, Delta High School natatorium renovation, Destiny Church 28,000 sq. ft. addition, and Amvets Post 12 pavilion.

- **Workshops & Conferences:** Staff attended the INDOT/Purdue LTAP "Road Wise" workshop at Cornerstone. The office is co-hosting the upcoming Indiana Metropolitan Planning Organization (MPO) / IARC conference in Kokomo from October 26–29.
- **Ordinance Update (Project UDO):** Kickoff meetings occurred with American Structure Point on July 6th for updating city and county unified development ordinances concurrently over a 14-month process. A \$5,000 rapid grant was secured from the Ball Brothers Foundation.
- **Department Budget:** County department budgets are being submitted this week for presentation to the County Council in September.
- **Adjournment:**
 - A motion to adjourn was made and seconded 00:50:49.
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote; meeting adjourned at 00:50:54.

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